

# TEAM LEADER MANUAL

BB STUDENTS RESOURCE

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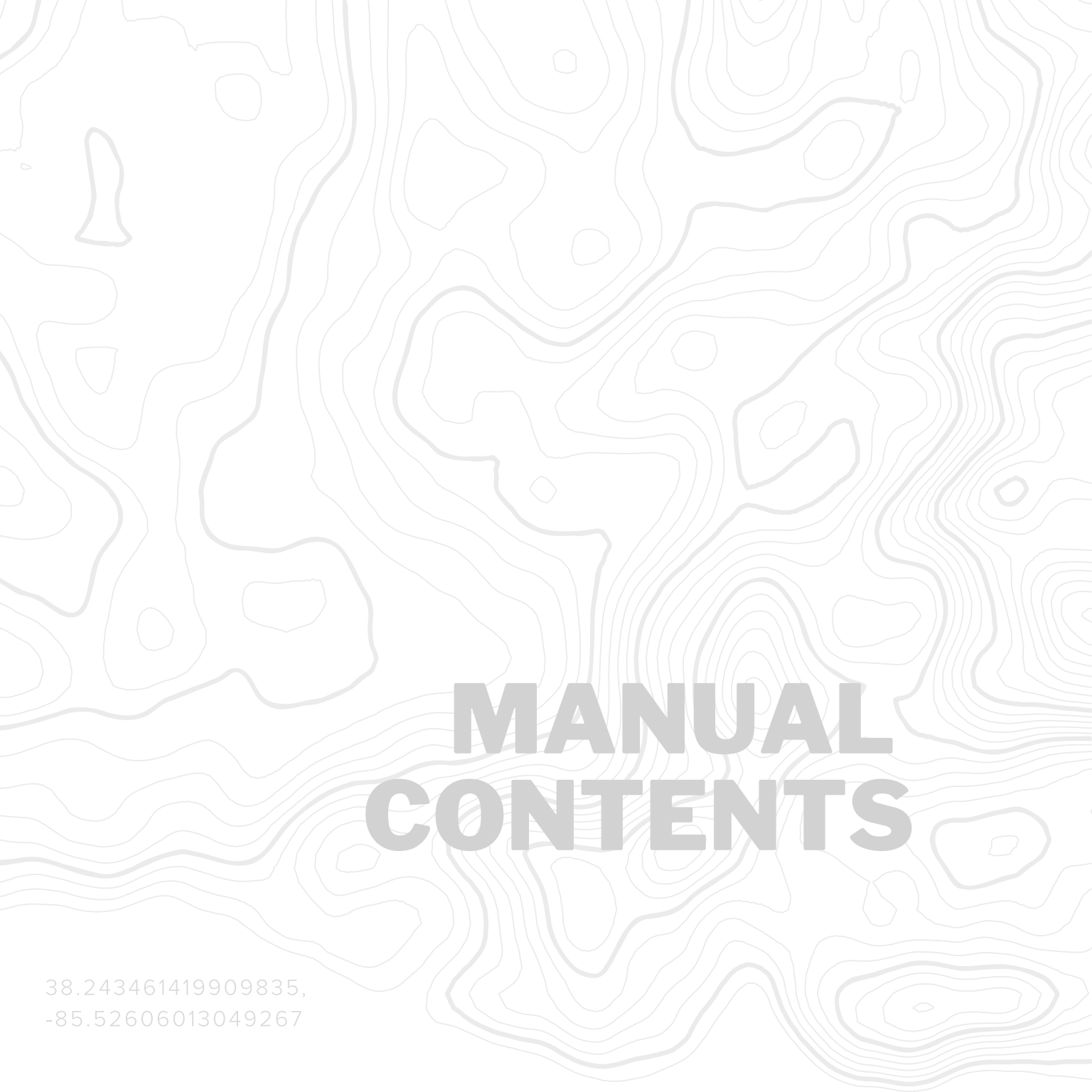
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# MISSION + MANTRAS

## WHO WE ARE

As members of the body of Christ, we seek Great Commission and Great Commandment living (Matthew 22:37-40; Matthew 28:18-20).

As members of this local body of Christ called Southeast, we seek to live this way through connecting people to Jesus and one-another, utilizing some metaphors based on the life of Christ to keep us focused.

You, as a team leader over a Student Ministry team, are the **culture carrier** of our Mission and Mantras. You should frequently use our mission and mantras as a GPS to keep our ministry efforts focused on accomplishing Great Commission and Great Commandment living.

**MISSION + MANTRAS**  
**WHO WE ARE**

**M** **SSION**

**CONNECTING**

**PEOPLE**

**TO JESUS**

**AND**

**ONE ANOTHER**

**V** **SION**

**TO UNLEASH**

**THE FULL FORCE**

**OF THE CHURCH**

**TO LOVE PEOPLE**

**ONE AT A TIME**

## BE THE BRANCH

( JOHN 15:1-17 )

We connect in community.

We value connection to Jesus over production for Jesus.

## CATCH THE WIND

( JOHN 3:1-8 )

We connect the full force of the church with the Holy Spirit.

We value risk and adventure over safety and comfort.

## WRECK THE ROOF

( LUKE 5:18-25 )

We will radically love people one at a time.

We value innovation over tradition.

## GRIP THE PLOW

( LUKE 9:57-62 )

We serve with intentional and focused effort.

We value personal engagement over attendance.

## EMPTY THE JAR

( LUKE 7:36-50 )

We connect through sacrificial generosity.

We value expressive worship over religious rituals.

The background of the entire image is a light gray topographic map. It features numerous thin, wavy contour lines that create a sense of depth and terrain. The lines are more densely packed in some areas, indicating steeper slopes, and more spread out in others, indicating flatter ground. The overall pattern is organic and flowing, covering the entire frame.

# **TEAM LEADERS**

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## TEAM LEADER

One word that best describes a Team Leader is shepherd. You win when your team feels cared for, knows where they are going, and accomplishes the mission God has given us. Keep the heart of a shepherd at the forefront of everything you do.

The primary reason you have this manual is to help you to better shepherd your team over time. In this section there are some key resources around expectations, building teams, developing others, and helping new leaders.

In further sections, you will be teed up for **Key Conversations** with the individuals on your team. These will be a mix of planned and "as you go" conversations. Another key to being a Team Leader is cultivating a team. To help unify the individuals that you lead, there is a section dedicated to helping facilitate **Team Dialogues**. Both of these sections are there for your support. You are free to add for your team's context, but this is the minimum we expect you to follow!

## LEADER CULTURE

IF JESUS WAS A TEAM LEADER

### RHYTHMS

**LUKE 9 MINISTRY TEAM**

→ TOOLS

### COMMUNITY

**“JESUS CALLED THE TWELVE TOGETHER...” (9:1A)**

→ HANGOUTS, HUDDLES, TEAM MEETINGS

### EQUIPPING

**“HE GAVE THEM POWER AND AUTHORITY...” (9:1B)**

→ UNLEASHED LEADERS

→ BIG 3, TRAININGS

### MISSION

**“HE SENT THEM OUT...” (9:2)**

→ SCHOOL ENGAGEMENT

→ COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

### CARE

**“THEY ALL ATE AND WERE SATISFIED...” (9:17)**

→ TEAM LEADERS, SHEPHERDING

### RETREAT

**“JESUS WAS PRAYING IN PRIVATE AND HIS DISCIPLES WERE WITH HIM...” (9:18)**

→ OVERNIGHTS, CELEBRATIONS

## STUDENT MINISTRY ROLE OVERVIEW

### STAFF ROLE

- Shepherding Team Leaders
- Keeping the whole ministry on mission
- Being examples to the flock ( 1 Peter 5:2-4 )
- Equipping Team Leaders

### TEAM LEADER ROLE

- Shepherding a team of leaders
- Keeping your team focused on the mission
- Setting the pace for your teams
- Leading by example for your team ( 1 Cor. 11:1 )

### LEADER ROLE

- Shepherding students
- Initiating investment in a few
- Living out your spiritual gifts in the context of your team and the ministry in which you serve

### SUPPORT LEADER ROLE

- Plugging new and unconnected students into the ministry
- Supporting ministry efforts
- Engaging students and families

## TEAM LEADER EXPECTATIONS

Being a Team Leader is a high calling. Team Leaders play a vital role in ensuring we have effective teams mobilized to multiply disciples all over the city of Louisville. Here are some of your expectations:

**1**

### LIVE THE MISSION

- Knowing the mission of student ministry, you set the pace for how your team can uniquely live that out to your students.
- Pray for, care for and coach leaders on your team.

**2**

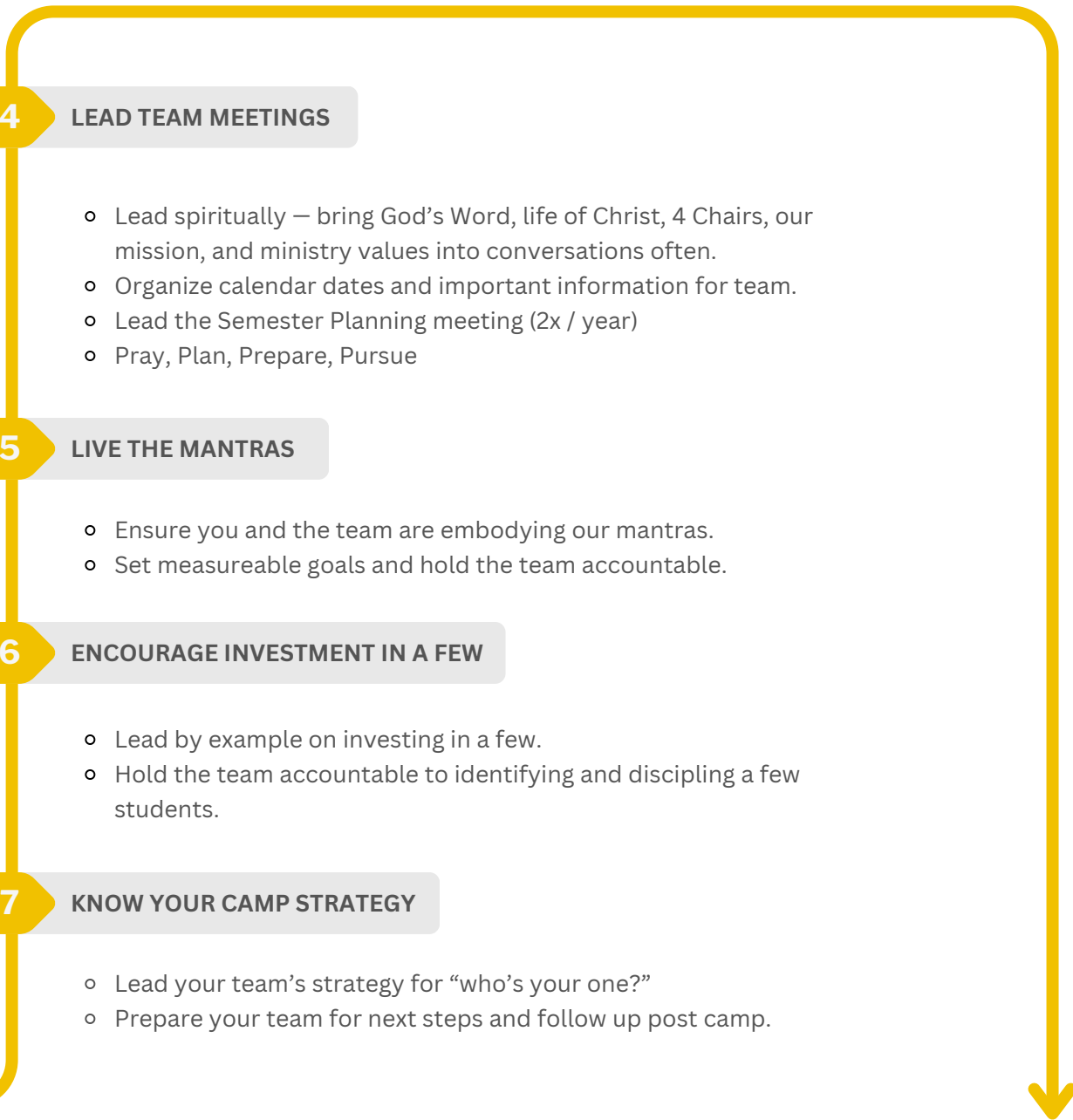
### MEET WITH LEADERS

- Ask them how their walk with Christ is going.
- Ask them about their life (family, work, school, hobbies, etc.)
- Ask them about their ministry using the Key Conversations.
- Pray together // Call to action

**3**

### OWN STUDENT CONNECTIONS FOR YOUR TEAM

- Ensure students are being invited regularly.
- In partnership with Check-In, have a plan for connecting new students into the right group with the right leader.
- Know and understand the different groups represented within your team.

A large yellow arrow on the left side of the page, pointing downwards, with a yellow outline and a yellow fill. It starts at the top and ends at the bottom, with a slight curve at the top and bottom.**4**

#### **LEAD TEAM MEETINGS**

- Lead spiritually — bring God’s Word, life of Christ, 4 Chairs, our mission, and ministry values into conversations often.
- Organize calendar dates and important information for team.
- Lead the Semester Planning meeting (2x / year)
- Pray, Plan, Prepare, Pursue

**5**

#### **LIVE THE MANTRAS**

- Ensure you and the team are embodying our mantras.
- Set measureable goals and hold the team accountable.

**6**

#### **ENCOURAGE INVESTMENT IN A FEW**

- Lead by example on investing in a few.
- Hold the team accountable to identifying and discipling a few students.

**7**

#### **KNOW YOUR CAMP STRATEGY**

- Lead your team’s strategy for “who’s your one?”
- Prepare your team for next steps and follow up post camp.

**8**

## **PARENT & COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS**

- Maintain relationships with parents and other community partners.
- Know the schools your students attend and identify partners within those schools.
- Always seek new leaders through these relationships.

**9**

## **EVALUATE WITH YOUR TEAM EACH SEMESTER**

- Look for where God is moving and praise him.
- Identify areas of improvement or need for course corrections.

**10**

## **CULTURE CARRIER**

- You set the temperature for your team. You bring the urgency for our mission to be lived out in your context.
- Be an example worth following.
- Be a branch that is connected to the vine (John 15).

“IF WE BELIEVE THE COMMAND  
TO **‘MAKE DISCIPLES’** IS BIGGER  
AND MORE BEAUTIFUL THAN  
MERELY MAKING CONVERTS  
AND CALLING PEOPLE TO  
‘MAKE A DECISION,’ THEN WE  
UNDERSTAND THE ESSENTIAL  
ROLE OF THE CHURCH IS  
MATURING PEOPLE IN CHRIST.”

— **ERIC GEIGER**

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# KEY CONVOS

## KEY CONVERSATIONS

Throughout the semester you will have plenty of side conversations, hall conversations, random conversations, text conversations and phone conversations with your team.

However, as a team leader, you are tasked with shepherding a team, and a shepherd doesn't randomly walk with his sheep. **A shepherd has a plan for where he is taking his sheep.**

The following pages include **Key Conversations** to have with individuals on your team. These are meant to be led in a one-on-one setting or, if necessary, in a one-on-a-few setting.

The reason these conversations are one-on-one is because honesty and vulnerability can be hard to achieve in group settings. Pulling aside your teammates for these conversations over time will be fruitful.

Depending on the size of your team, you might need more or less time to accomplish these conversations. They will require you to intentionally put days and times on the calendar.

Our prayer is that these conversations grow your friendships with your teammates, as well as set you up to lead them like Jesus.

## AUG → SPIRITUAL INVENTORY



## SPIRITUAL INVENTORY

Send the **Spiritual Disciplines Evaluation** document to your leaders before you meet up. Use it as a base for conversation around how they are doing spiritually.

- Entering into this school year, where is your spiritual health?
- How has your quiet time with Jesus been? How regularly are you spending time alone with God?
- What have you been praying about?
- Where has God been growing you? What would you like God to grow you in this year?

## LOOKING AHEAD

- How do you think you can best contribute to our team this year? What can you uniquely bring to the table?
- What do you need from me to help you succeed as a leader?

Before our next meet up, please take the **4 Chair Disciple Making Personal Inventory** ( QR above ). We will be discussing the results!

*Scripture: Hebrews 12:11*

## KEY CONVERSATIONS

**SEPT → 4 CHAIRS**

## 4 CHAIRS

- What challenge from Jesus goes with Chair 1? Chair 2? Chair 3? Chair 4?
- Based on the *4 Chair Disciple Making Inventory*, what chair do you sit in? Do you agree or disagree? Why?
- What rhythm could you add, or change, in your life to help you get to the next chair?
- Read John 15. What level of fruitfulness are you currently experiencing? No fruit, Fruit, More Fruit or Much Fruit?

## LOOKING AHEAD

- How could you use the 4 Challenges of Jesus (4 Chairs) to help you better understand where students are and how to help them move to the next seat?

As you form relationships with students in your grade, begin thinking about which chair each of them might be sitting in. The purpose of doing this is not to judge where someone is, but to help you identify how you might help them take their next step!

*Scripture: 1 John 2:6*

## KEY CONVERSATIONS

## OCT → SMALL GROUP

## SMALL GROUP

- How has small group started off for you?
- Do you know the names of your students? Do they know each other's names?
- Have you been able to connect with some of your students outside of group time?

## GROUP EVALUATION: FOUR CHAIRS

To the best of your understanding, what percentage of the students in your group are in each chair?

CHAIR 1 \_\_\_\_\_% CHAIR 2 \_\_\_\_\_% CHAIR 3 \_\_\_\_\_% CHAIR 4 \_\_\_\_\_%

List the names of some students in each chair.

|       |       |       |       |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1     | 2     | 3     | 4     |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |

What is your plan for helping students get to the next seat spiritually?

## LOOKING AHEAD

Next month we'll meet to talk about your few. I hope that you can bring at least 3 names of students that you are personally investing in.



# TEAM DIALOGUES

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## TEAM DIALOGUES

Each month, pull your team together for a team meeting to dialogue about important details of your ministry so that everyone can stay on the same page.

These meetings should be planned, preferably at a reoccurring time, for the best turnout. You will need to identify with your team what is the best day or time for everyone.

At times, these meetings will require sacrifice for some of your teammates. This can be tricky, but you might recommend the need for rearranging people's schedules to make this time a priority.

If good friendships are building in the team, over time you will find a rhythm that works and people should naturally make it a priority to spend time together as a team!

Obviously things come up and people might not be able to make it from time to time. In that case you will need to relay important details, but never cancel your standing meeting or you may do more harm than good to the culture of consistency.

The following pages are monthly **Team Dialogues** for you to address with your team. This does not mean that you need to spend your entire time together on these subjects. We hope you share meals, hang out, etc. as part of these times together!

## AUG → SEMESTER PLANNING



## SEMESTER PLANNING

The goal of this planning session is to do the hard work up front so everyone can know what to expect during the semester.

Have everyone come prepared with their notable calendar dates for the semester.

- Vacation, Trips, etc.
- Celebrations, family birthdays, etc.
- Any time they expect to be unable to lead

Walk through the Ministry Calendar covering leader dates, events, and any other fixed calendar items. As you walk through those dates together, encourage your team to share any kind of conflict they might have. Put their notable dates down so you can reference later.

This would be a good time to map out your Team Meeting dates that go beyond our Leader Huddles. If your team is able to plan any extra student events beyond program time, it'd be a huge win to leave this meeting with those dates locked in.

Over the course of the semester you can move things around as needed, add or subtract, but do so as a team. Everyone will feel better prepared if everyone can agree and see what is upcoming!

## LOOKING AHEAD

Next month we will look to mobilize groups beyond our regular ministry time.

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# **BIG THREE**

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## BIG THREE

Three times a year we gather ALL our Student Ministry Leaders together. These are high priority events for our ministry. We expect you and your team to be fully present.

**LEADER LAUNCH** = Vision Cast + Launch into New School Year

**LEADER NIGHT** = Reset + Recast Vision for Second Semester

**LEADER CELEBRATION** = Celebrate all that God has Done

The Big Three are also a pivotal part of our onboarding process for new leaders. Connected to each of the Big Three, we host an Unleashed Leader Training for all new and potential leaders to on-ramp into our ministry.

**UNLEASHED LEADERS** = Two-Week Deep Dive Into Our “Why”

We also have flexibility around how we can onboard new leaders if we aren’t near one of those planned starting points. Please be in-tune with these dates each year. We need you to champion them to your teams!

# BIG THREE TIPS



## LEADER LAUNCH

( AUGUST )

- The time to consider Leader Launch is May.
- Recruit to Camp = Recruit to Fall

## LEADER NIGHT

( JANUARY )

- The time to consider Leader Night is August.
- Get this on your leaders' calendars early and remind them.

## LEADER CELEBRATION

( MAY )

- The time to consider Leader Night is January.
- Might be a starting point for some new leaders going to camp.

Your participation at each of these keystone moments during the school year is vital. We believe these moments together as a Student Ministry are foundational to keeping us aligned.

## UNLEASHED LEADERS

( ALL YEAR )

Preceding each of the Big Three is another foundational part of our ministry: Unleashed Leaders. Unleashed Leaders is a training opportunity for new leaders that we expect every new leader to go through.

This training sets up our new leaders to learn about who we are as a Student Ministry. We want to ensure that everyone looking to join our ministry, whether to lead a group or serve at check-in, knows that our primary aim is to make disciples. We take a look at the life of Christ and allow it to inform how we approach ministry.

Since Jesus himself continually raised the bar for his disciples, we look to inform those joining us about the cost of following Jesus upfront, so later they aren't surprised by what we ask of them.

In some ways, it can appear as if we are talking people out of doing ministry. In actuality, we are just echoing Jesus' call to make disciples. Even some who heard it straight from Jesus' mouth chose not to follow.

Obviously, one of our primary values is grace and we know things happen, but being up front about the commitment pays dividends when leaders know what they are signing up for and stick it out.

We love the community of leaders God has blessed us with. We get to fulfill Jesus' mission together!

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# **FURTHER RESOURCES**

## FURTHER RESOURCES

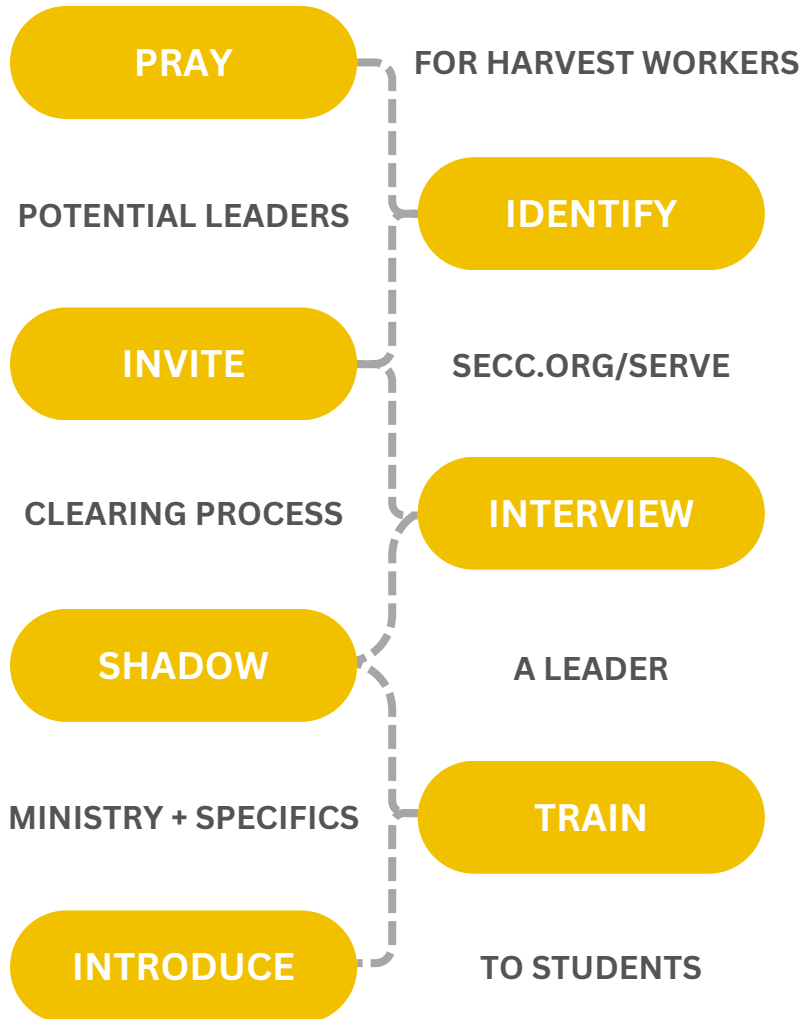
We believe in you as a leader. As a leader leading other leaders, your role is vital to our ministry to students. We desire to equip you spiritually just as much as we desire to equip you with ministry resources.

That is why you have this booklet in the first place. Mixed throughout it are resources that we hope you find valuable personally and in your team leader role.

The rest of this booklet is a compilation of resources to be used à la carte. We might reference these during our Team Leader Meetings at times, but they are there for you to explore and use at your own desire and pace.

## CONNECTING NEW LEADERS

### FIRST STEPS



## NEW LEADERS

Over time you will add new leaders onto your team. Leaders can come from a lot of places and at different times throughout the year, and we want to make sure they join our ministry well.

Potential leaders are invited to fill out the interest form on our website. From there, it will notify the staff and initiate the onboarding process. Staff will work with Team Leaders in various ways to create the best experience possible for a potential leader joining our ministry.

Once a leader is placed onto your team, identifying their gifting early on can help you better understand what they bring to your team. That is why we recommend that you take them through the [High5test](#) to help identify some of the strengths that they might bring to the team.

Looking at the strengths of each of your teammates can help you better lead them to take ownership over different aspects of your ministry to students.

It is **your job** to help your team play to their strengths, offering their gifts in service to God's Kingdom.



## NEW LEADER NAMES

## CASE STUDY OF AN EFFECTIVE TEAM

Jesus had a team of 12 guys who were his “called out” ones. This team functioned like any other ministry team, serving others together, sharing the gospel, going to unreached places, loving those who came their way, etc.

Let’s take a look at two quick accounts of this ministry team:

**READ**

**LUKE 9:46-50. WHAT WERE THE DISCIPLES ARGUING ABOUT?**

**READ**

**LUKE 22:24-27. WHAT IS DIFFERENT ABOUT THIS CONFRONTATION?**

Let’s look to Matthew’s Gospel for more context.

**READ**

**MATTHEW 20:20-28. HOW DID JESUS ADDRESS THIS ISSUE?**

**THINK**

**WHAT WOULD HAVE HAPPENED IF JESUS DIDN’T ADDRESS THIS ISSUE?**

As a Team Leader, you act as a unifier for your team. There will be instances when disagreements, misunderstandings, or flat out ignorance takes place. At times, you might become a source of such situations. That is why you must look to Christ for how to handle team interactions.

Jesus wasn’t just full *of* grace and truth—Jesus led *from* grace and truth. Your team needs you to lead like Jesus, willing to speak the hard truths full of grace, before disunity arises.

# BUILDING AN EFFECTIVE TEAM



## DEFINE GOALS AND PURPOSE UP FRONT

*Teams that lack direction usually fizzle out.*

- How will your team practically live on mission?
- Can you rally around a common goal?



## DEFINE FRAMEWORK

*A framework provides structure to operate within.*

- How does your team share responsibilities?
- Does your team understand how things are suppose to work?



## DEFINE COMMUNICATION

*The thread for your team to know what is going on.*

- What is your method(s) of communication?
- How / when will 1-on-1's / team meetings be accomplished?



## DEFINE ACCOUNTABILITY

*Accountability creates trust and deepens commitment.*

- As the team leader, do you allow yourself to be held accountable?
- How is your team accountable to one another?



## DEFINE UNITY

*Unity is the fruit of deep commitment to one another*

- When frustration develops on the team, how do we handle it?
- Can your team disagree and still feel valued and loved?

## MANTRA QUESTIONS



**BE THE BRANCH**

( JOHN 15:1-17 )

**CATCH THE WIND**

( JOHN 3:1-8 )

**WRECK THE ROOF**

( LUKE 5:18-25 )

**GRIP THE PLOW**

( LUKE 9:57-62 )

**EMPTY THE JAR**

( LUKE 7:36-50 )



How is my connection to the vine?  
How is my team's connection to the vine?  
How could I encourage my team to stay connected?



Where is the Spirit moving in our church in a way that our team and students could join?  
Where is the Spirit moving in our community and how can we jump in?  
What risk will we take this semester that causes us to truly depend on God to move?



How could we reach more students in this city?  
Who is my one? Who are my students' ones?



Where do I find myself making excuses to avoid ministry?  
Where might God be asking me to focus my ministry efforts?



Where can I spend and be spent for the sake of others to know Christ? ( 2 Cor. 12:15 )  
Am I generous with my time and availability to others?  
Where could I sacrifice more (and likely experience deeper dependence on God)?

## FIVE HELPFUL STEPS TO DEVELOPING LEADERS 1X

Not everyone is born with natural leadership skills. Yes, it is true that God gifts certain people with skills that he calls them to live out, but leadership is more so caught through watching qualified people than it is through your own individuality. Since this is true, we seek to follow a simple model of leader development below.

1

**I DO. YOU WATCH. WE TALK.**

An experienced leader takes a new leader and gives them a time to observe him or her. This can also be referred to as shadowing. After a few times observing, the experienced leader and new leader should meet to discuss what was observed. This debriefing time should include three simple questions: (1) “What worked?” (2) “What didn’t work?” and (3) “How can we improve?” The process of debriefing should continue throughout the rest of the development.

2

**I DO. YOU HELP. WE TALK.**

In this phase of the development, the experienced leader gives the new leader an opportunity to help lead in a particular area. For example, if someone is being developed to lead a small group, the experienced leader might ask the new leader to lead the announcements and prayer time while the experienced leader leads the talk and discussion. This experience should still be followed up with a one-on-one chat.

**3**

**YOU DO. I HELP. WE TALK.**

Now the new leader transitions from supporting or helping to taking leadership responsibilities. The experienced leader follows up to debrief their experience.

**4**

**YOU DO. I WATCH. WE TALK.**

The new leader is almost ready to lead on their own. The new leader has the opportunity to fulfill all the functions of leadership, with the more experienced leader now looking on and watching the new leader in action.

**5**

**YOU DO.**

The new leader is now successfully leading in our ministry and is placed on your team.

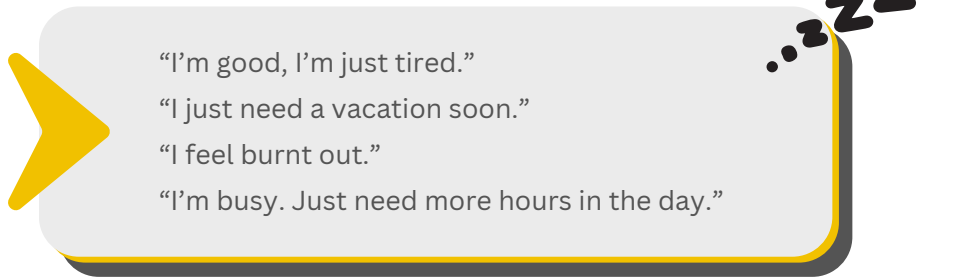
**“BUSYNESS DOES NOT MEAN  
YOU ARE A FAITHFUL OR  
FRUITFUL CHRISTIAN. IT ONLY  
MEANS YOU ARE BUSY, JUST  
LIKE EVERYONE ELSE. AND LIKE  
EVERYONE ELSE, YOUR JOY,  
YOUR HEART AND YOUR SOUL  
ARE IN DANGER.”**

**— KEVIN DEYOUNG**

## REST

Rest might be one of the most important, yet often neglected priorities in our relationship with God. Someone's perspective on rest can tell you a lot about them.

**Think about the last time you heard:**



**Now think about the last time you said something around those lines.**

*Gut check number 1.* The good news is that Jesus provides us a solution to our hurried living. In fact, he modeled a life of rest amidst the demands of his everyday life. Jesus was in-tune with his deep need to connect to the Father.

**Our ability to lead people often hinges on our ability to rest well.**

*Gut check number 2.* Disagree? Rest reveals a posture of the heart that is deeply dependent upon God. We must continually check ourselves. How much stock do I put in my production *for* Christ over my connectedness *to* Christ?

If you find yourself weary, this resource might be good to do yourself before you try and lead others into it. Whether for you or for your team, check out this **“Eremos Place”** Solitary Retreat Guide to help get you reconnected to the Vine.

